Yan Feng

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EDUCATION

University of California Irvine **Irvine, CA, United States**

Education Policy and Social Context, PhD Student *Expected Sep.2025-June.2030*

Harvard University **Cambridge, MA, United States**

Educational Policy and Analysis, Master of Education *Aug.2023–May.2024*

- **GPA:** 3.89/4

East China Normal University (ECNU) **Shanghai, China**

Higher Education, Master of Education *Sept.2018–June.2021*

- **GPA:** 3.86/4 **Ranking:** 1/18

East China University of Science and Technology (ECUST) **Shanghai, China**

Public Utility Administration, Bachelor of Management *Aug.2014–July.2018*

- **GPA:** 3.71/4 **Ranking:** 3/58

PUBLICATIONS & FORMAL ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

Publications:

- Li L., & **Feng Y.** (2019). The knowledge genealogy of international Chinese education research: Theme and frontier analysis. *Exploring Education Development*, 8(3), 17–24.
- Yang J., & **Feng Y.** (2017). Urban women's emotional self-expression and identity construction: The empirical explanation of public square dance group. *Fujian Tribune, The Humanities & Social Science*, 7(3), 96–102.

Conference Presentations:

- Yun, H., Sung, G., **Feng, Y**., & Schneider, B. (2025). Emerging Debugging Strategies of Novice Programmers: The Role of Self-Efficacy. In Rajala, A., Cortez, A., Hofmann, R., Jornet, A., Lotz-Sisitka, H., & Markauskaite, L. (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 19th International Conference of the Learning Sciences - ICLS 2025 (pp. 3221-3223). International Society of the Learning Sciences.*
- Li L., & **Feng Y.** (2020, October). A case study of supervisory relationships through the perspective of emotion labor. *Presented at the 6th Forum on Empirical Education Research.* Shanghai, China
- **Feng Y.** (2020, October). Explore the phenomenon of university dropouts: A qualitative study of five undergraduates' dropout-reenrolled cases. *Presented at the 6th Forum on Empirical Education Research.* Shanghai, China

Ongoing Paper:

- **Feng, Y.,** & Li, L. (in preparation). *Emotional Labor and Supervisory Relationships in Doctoral Supervision: A Qualitative Study in Chinese Universities.* To be submitted to *Studies in Higher Education, Dec 2024*.

RESEARCH WORKING EXPERIENCE

NSF-CAREER Grant: Cultivating Environmental Science Data Agency Through Data Storytelling and Issue-Based Learning

Research Assistant | Principal Investigator: Dr. Ke Li ***University of Nevada, Reno, 2024(Ongoing)***

- Co-designed a data-driven, justice-oriented curriculum on wildfires for U.S. K-12 education, integrating real-world environmental data with scientific data storytelling to enhance STEM learning
- Co-developed future data collection procedures for different stages (2024–2029), including interviews (e.g., with students/teachers/Indigenous groups/other stakeholders), classroom observations, video recording, survey design, and materials for teacher professional development sessions; Designed CODAP tool for data storytelling activity

- Refined research proposals for the National Science Foundation (NSF) and Institutional Review Board review; Led weekly team meetings to oversee framework design and coordinate research activities; Applied literature on STEM education and data storytelling to shape the project design and activities.

Novice Programmer Stress: Patterns, Implications, and Multimodal Prediction
Research Assistant | Collaborator: Dr. Gahyun Callie Sung & Dr. Bertrand Schneider ***Harvard, 2024(Ongoing)***

- RA in Harvard LIT (Learning, Innovation and Technology) Lab; Facilitated and collected data from a series of 3-day Python workshops (2023-2024), investigating affect and motivation in STEM learning through self-regulation and problem-solving perspective
- Used mixed methods, combining design-based and data analytic approaches to examine the stress experienced by novice computer science students; Analyzed multimodal data, including surveys, sensor-based momentary stress assessments, frontal face videos, and log data, to evaluate emotional stress and its impact on the learning performance
- Conducted 15 transcriptions, literature review, and research framework; Designed initial coding scheme, coded 1,230 units of qualitative interview data using ELAN, double-coded to ensure inter-rater reliability
- Co-authored academic papers for the conferences and peer-reviewed journals

Evaluating the Effectiveness of Practice-Based Approaches to Developing Preservice Teachers' skill with Acknowledging Competence
Research/Teaching Assistant | Supervisors: Dr. Heather Hill & Dr. Francesca Forzani ***Harvard, 2024(ongoing)***

- Led intervention groups of over 50 HGSE TTL (Teaching and Teacher Leadership) Program preservice teachers and facilitated training sessions focused on developing their skills in acknowledging student competence to promote education equity and enhance teacher preparation
- Managed data collection and RCT implementation, ensuring participant confidentiality and supporting interventions through pre-work assessments and classroom simulations; Monitored the effectiveness of different practice-based approaches (video analysis and reading discussion) across assigned groups
- Analyzed post-intervention teaching outcomes by coding and evaluating 120 video recordings of teachers' independent teaching practices; Assessed teacher positioning behaviors to measure TTL training success; Collaborated in weekly coding discussions to refine frameworks and ensure consistency across the research team

Explore the Impact of Faculty-student Ratio on Retention Rate in US Higher Education
Project Leader | Supervisor: Dr. Joe McIntyre ***Harvard, 2023***

- Proposed and Led a student research group investigating the relationship between faculty-student ratio and retention rates in U.S. higher education, with a focus on student-teacher dynamics under institutional retention policy
- Used R software to combine and clean 6 raw data files from IPEDS 2021 with an overall data dimension of 296,365 observations of 123 variables; Fitted multiple logistic regression in a sample size of 2,167 post-secondary institutions
- Discovered and visualized a significantly positive relationship between faculty-student ratio and retention rate by ggplot2; Applied hierarchical multiple regression to measure the effect of blocks of institutional finance status and related characteristics variables on student retention outcomes

Emotional Labor and Supervisory Relationships in Doctoral Supervision: A Qualitative Study in Chinese Universities
Project Leader ***ECNU, 2019–2024***

- Led the study to examine supervisory relationships through a sociology lens, with implications for higher education policy analysis; Conducted semi-structured focus group interviews with 32 supervisors and 28 doctoral students, and coded qualitative data using NVIVO
- Discovered that both supervisors and students heavily engage in surface acting to fake or hide emotions, resulting in extra emotional labor and bad supervisory relationships; Identified how students' academic performance, engagement, emotional and mental stress, and teachers' role identification and enthusiasm all suffer, making both sides less creative and intellectually productive; Vague university mentoring and grievance policies intensify these challenges
- Presented the prework at the *6th Forum on Empirical Education Research* (Conference, 2020); First-authored an academic paper currently under peer review for a journal submission.

Master Thesis: Attribution, Reborn Process, and Identity Reconstruction of Undergraduate Dropouts' Phenomenon in Chinese Elite Universities: A Qualitative Study

Supervisor: Dr. Linlin Li ***ECNU, 2021***

- Conducted a qualitative case study on the phenomenon of undergraduate dropouts in Chinese elite universities to study their mobility, identity, and the effectiveness of retention and dropout policies
- Conducted semi-structured interviews with 14 undergraduates to understand their life experience; Used netnography to observe 100+ netizens' posts on the topic '#Drop out of university' on top 2 Chinese social media (2019-2021)
- Discovered Chinese universities lack well-developed school/credit transfer systems to provide dropouts with alternatives, dropouts fail in academic and social integration, and dropouts' families have high educational expectations, leaving many dropouts feeling ashamed - creating both an identity crisis and an opportunity to rebuild self-identity
- Earned award for 2021 Excellent Dissertation at East China Normal University *(49 selected from 2,000 submissions)*

Shanghai Online Teaching & Learning Survey for Teachers during COVID-19 Pandemic (SOTL-T)

Project Member | Supervisor: Dr. Guangcai Yan & Dr. Jiao Guo ***ECNU, 2019–2021***

- A large-scale survey to investigate online teaching experience and other COVID-19 changes in teaching and learning
- Collected questionnaires from 11,188 teachers with various demographic backgrounds from 76 universities in Shanghai, analyzed the data with Stata, interviewed 23 teachers to collect their suggestions for future online teaching
- Discovered, through correlation and regression analysis results; Drafted research report
- Coordinated weekly meetings with Shanghai Education Commission on potential policy reforms related to online teaching (e.g., how to help schools standardize their digital education strategies and establish better teaching platforms to ensure the success of online learning)

What Are Students Doing in Online Classes? A Study of Online Learning Behavior **Shanghai, China**

Project Leader *ECNU, 2019–2020*

- Used a fill-in-the-blank question in a valid sample of 36,292 undergraduates based on SOTL-T's existing survey data
- Applied a machine learning model to explore online learning behaviors and associated factors
- Used continuous bag-of-words to embed the word and the conditional random field-based model to separate the word and then trained the data to construct classification models
- Identified nine behavioral manifestations, including 33 behavioral components, divided them into 3 major categories of learning behavior, and found 38.3% of undergrads admitted to explicit truancy behaviors (e.g., dozing, leaving freely, engaging in recreation) and 31.2% admitted to invisible truancy behaviors (e.g., distraction, self-study)
- Extracted other influence factors (e.g., self-study time, class size, gender, and family income)

The Global Impact of China's Educational Research

Research Assistant | Supervisor: Dr. Gang Ding & Dr. Hantian Wu ***ECNU, 2018–2020***

- Reviewed the development of International Chinese Education Research and its knowledge network
- Analyzed 5,992 papers about Chinese education published in 2000–2018 from SSCI using CiteSpace, generating 13 cutting-edge themes and showing how the frontier trend changed in chronological order
- Identified how, compared to Chinese domestic education research, international education research focuses more on the themes with Chinese and has a strong quantitative methodological orientation influenced by Western pragmatism
- Published article on the research in one of the Chinese top journals, *Exploring Education Development* (2019)

A Narrative Research on the Impact of Teacher's Behavior on Student's Learning

Project Leader ***ECNU, 2018–2019***

- Conducted phone interviews with 15 graduates, reviewed 40+ research articles, and coded qualitative data via NVIVO
- Identified how many undergrads believe teacher behavior does not significantly impact academic achievement due to interactions being typically focused on teaching behavior (e.g., completing courses, earning degrees), but do not feel sufficiently engaged in academic activities, especially among career-oriented students
- Won a research scholarship from the Education Department of East China Normal University (2019)

The Change of Lifestyle of Square Dancers in China's Urbanization

Project Member | Supervisor: Dr. Jun Yang ***ECUST, 2016–2018***

- Interviewed 30 public "square dancers" (elderly females dancing in squares or parks) from 3 Shanghai communities
- Developed the theoretical framework using Baker's individualization theory, and found that square dancing became an everyday way for urban women to rebuild their individual identities by escaping from family for short periods
- Published the article in a core Chinese journal*, Fujian Tribune, The Humanities & Social Science* (2018)

COURSE TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Course: EDUS040 Introductory and Intermediate Statistics for Educational Research: Applied Linear Regression, Harvard Graduate School of Education(HGSE) Cambridge, MA
Teaching Fellow *2024(Ongoing)*

- Led weekly sections on data analysis projects using R and Stata, guiding students to apply various statistical tests; Conducted weekly office hours and programming sessions to provide support
- Graded weekly assignments and gave individualized feedback on monthly student research projects, helping students frame research questions, conduct analyses, and accurately interpret their test results
- Collaborated with the Professor to develop course materials and assessments, ensuring clear delivery of complex statistical concepts and effectively addressing student challenges.

Undergraduate Course: Education and Self Development (ECNU)
Graduate Course: Introduction of Qualitative Research (ECNU) Shanghai, China
Teaching Assistant and Seminar Leader *2019–2021*

- Helped design the course syllabus, including Interview Skills and Grounded Theory of graduate core course
- Coordinated one-hour academic seminar sessions after each class, supervised students' reading and essay writing
- Corrected 79 homework essays monthly, checked attendance, and summarized student questions and feedback

OTHER WORKING EXPERIENCE

Class Gift Program, Harvard Graduate School of Education Cambridge, MA
Volunteer *2023-2024*

- Contributed to financial aid fundraising, generating donations to support future student scholarships; Addressed international students' challenges and strategized solutions in weekly meetings
- Promoted the program through alumni outreach, social media, event posters, and webpage design to effectively share program information and increase engagement.

International School of Arts Canada Toronto, Canada
Course Designer and Academic Advisor *2021–2024*

- Designed summer programs that combine arts education with community service and local culture for both local and international K-12 students, enhancing the social impact of arts learning
- Advised students, particularly disadvantaged ones, on academic interests and college plans, providing personalized tutoring and guidance to support their success.

Office of the President, East China Normal University(ECNU) Shanghai, China
Administrative Intern *2019–2021*

- Assisted daily with students' and teachers' consultations and administration of office documents and meetings
- Collected info on-campus educational activities and policy implementation; wrote monthly briefs to administrators

CORE SKILLS

- **Language:** English (TOEFL 115), Mandarin (native)
- **Skill:** R (proficient), Stata (proficient), SPSS (proficient), CODAP (proficient), NVIVO (proficient), ELAN (proficient), CiteSpace (proficient), Microsoft Office (proficient), Python(basic), Photoshop (basic)
- **Hobbies:** Piano (amateur level 10), Dance (Shanghai Campus Street Dance Crew Competition, 2nd place)
- **Honor:** Excellent Dissertation of ECNU (Top 49 out of 2,000 submissions), Excellent Dissertation of Faculty of Education, Publishing Wisdom Scholarship (Top 100 out of 8,712 applicants), Excellent Thesis of ECUST, Student Excellence Scholarship, First Prize for Social Work